

**Single Source Justification (Simplified Acquisition)**

**Section A: General Contract Information**

Is this a Bridge Action as defined in the [AF Bridge Action Reduction Plan](#)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Contracting Activity: PZ (Arnold) OL Holloman

Project/Program Name: 900-ton Crane Rental

Purchase Request / Local ID Number: F2ETGT6075A101

Estimated Contract Cost (including Options): [REDACTED]

**Section B: Description of the Supplies/Services Required**

This requirement is for a short-term, all-inclusive rental of a 900-ton mobile crane for the Holloman High Speed Test Track (HHSTT) at Holloman AFB from approximately April 1, 2026, to April 24, 2026.

The service is needed to mitigate a critical mission delay. The government-owned crane used to move large concrete targets for rocket-sled testing has suffered an unexpected failure, halting preparations for an upcoming test mission. This service will provide a temporary replacement, ensuring the necessary heavy-lift capability is available to move the targets and keep a critical National Defense program on schedule.

The contract will be for a turn-key service, meaning the contractor must provide the 900-ton crane, all necessary support equipment, and a fully certified crew to perform the transport, setup, operation, and removal of the equipment.

**Section C: Justification for Soliciting from a Single Source or Brand Name**

This sole source acquisition is justified under the authority of FAR 6.302-2, "Unusual and Compelling Urgency," as implemented by 10 U.S.C. § 3204(a)(2). The 846th Test Squadron's primary 200-ton crane has suffered a critical failure, halting all preparatory activities for rocket-sled test missions. This work stoppage has reduced mission capability by an estimated 60% and directly jeopardizes 10 scheduled missions, each valued at approximately \$1 million, creating a potential financial loss of up to \$10 million and risking the timely delivery of tested systems to the warfighter. The need for an immediate heavy-lift crane service is of such an unusual and compelling urgency that the United States Government would be seriously injured unless the agency is permitted to limit the number of sources solicited. A standard competitive acquisition timeline would introduce an unacceptable delay, directly causing the serious injury described above.

To address this urgent need, thorough market research was conducted to identify all viable solutions. First, utilizing GSA Schedules for heavy equipment rental was considered. However, this process requires issuing a Request for Quote (RFQ) and allowing for a competitive response and evaluation period, a timeline estimated to take several weeks. This would not satisfy the immediate operational need and would cause an unacceptable slip in the mission schedule. Consequently, direct vendor outreach was performed. A non-local vendor, [REDACTED], offered two solutions: a fixed rail system that was technically unsuitable for mission requirements, and a technically acceptable mobile crawler crane with a budgetary cost of nearly [REDACTED] driven primarily by extensive mobilization costs. In contrast, a local vendor, RMS Cranes, offered a technically equivalent mobile crane solution at a quoted price of \$427,394.

This market research clearly demonstrates that RMS Cranes is the only source capable of providing a timely and cost-effective solution. Proceeding with a sole-source award to RMS Cranes avoids the unacceptable mission delays of a competitive process and saves the government over [REDACTED] compared to the only other identified vendor. Therefore, this action is the only timely and fiscally responsible solution available to prevent serious injury to the mission.

**Section D: Efforts to Obtain Competition**

Efforts were made to obtain competition by surveying the commercial marketplace for sources capable of meeting the government's heavy-lift requirement. This market research included direct engagement with two known vendors in the crane

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and rigging industry. The government first engaged with [REDACTED] a non-local provider. Following a site visit, Barnhart required two weeks to develop a verbal budgetary estimate, which they provided on March 3, 2026. This verbal estimate was approximately [REDACTED] comprising roughly [REDACTED] for mobilization and demobilization and [REDACTED] for labor. As of the writing of this justification—four weeks after the initial site visit—a formal written quote has still not been provided despite repeated requests. This significant delay in receiving basic quoting information demonstrates an unacceptable risk to the project schedule and an inability to meet the Government's urgent timeline.

In parallel, market research identified RMS Cranes of Albuquerque, a local source. RMS Cranes provided a complete, actionable quote in less than 24 hours from the initial request. Their quote of \$427,394 was not only substantially lower, but their demonstrated responsiveness provided a high degree of confidence in their ability to meet the urgent performance schedule. Therefore, while competition was sought, the market research concluded that only one vendor demonstrated the capability and responsiveness required to mitigate the serious injury to the government's mission in a timely and cost-effective manner.

### **Section E: Steps to Preclude Future Single Source or Brand Name Awards**

The steps being taken to foster competition in the future and preclude the need for similar urgent, sole-source acquisitions are focused on addressing the root cause of the current situation: the unexpected failure of a critical government asset.

First, the 846th Test Squadron is actively pursuing the expedited repair of the government-owned 200-ton Shuttlelift Gantry Crane to restore full operational capability.

Second, a comprehensive review of the preventative maintenance schedule and procedures for the gantry crane will be conducted to identify and mitigate potential failure points before they become mission-critical.

Finally, and most importantly, the 704 Test Group will explore the establishment of a competitive, multiple-award Indefinite Delivery/Indefinite Quantity (IDIQ) contract or a Basic Ordering Agreement (BOA) for on-call heavy equipment rental services. By competing and pre-pricing this requirement in advance, the government will have a mechanism to rapidly obtain crane services from a pool of qualified vendors in the event of a future emergency, thereby ensuring competition and eliminating the need for a sole-source justification under urgent circumstances.

### **Section F: Contracting Officer's Determination**

I have determined, in accordance with [FAR 13.106-1\(b\)\(1\)](#), that the circumstances of this contract action deem only a single source is reasonably available.

|             |                                                  |                                                                                                                                        |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Date        | Typed Name and Rank/Grade of Contracting Officer | Signature of Contracting Officer                                                                                                       |
| 23-Mar-2026 | Brett Moore NH03                                 | MOORE.BRETT.T.1384062187<br>7<br><small>Digitally signed by<br/>MOORE.BRETT.T.1384062187<br/>Date: 2026.03.23 10:54:36 -06'00'</small> |